LITTLE WONDERS ESL

Chemistry Word Lab: Carbon

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · from pencils to diamonds



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I am clear and extremely hard. I am a gem in rings, and I am made only of carbon.
2. I am soft, dark grey and slippery. People often call me lead, but I am made only of carbon.
3. I am a tool for writing and drawing. My black centre is made of a soft form of carbon.

2 COOL FACT: SAME ATOMS, DIFFERENT MATERIALS

Carbon is an element, and it is in all living things. Pure carbon can look very different. **Diamond** is clear and extremely hard, and people use it in jewellery and in tools that cut. **Graphite** is soft, dark grey and slippery. It is the black part of a **pencil**, which people often call the lead, but there is no lead in it. Diamond and graphite are both made only of carbon **atoms**, but the atoms are joined in different ways. Carbon is also in **coal**.

jewellery = rings and necklaces
lead = a heavy, soft grey metal
extremely = very, very
joined = connected

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

C	J	E	G	R	A	P	H	I	T	E	T
A	O	I	D	E	K	E	O	G	M	I	H
R	Y	O	I	A	D	Q	L	R	O	L	A
B	C	T	A	C	F	O	C	S	U	F	R
O	O	E	M	N	E	E	E	A	L	X	D
N	A	T	O	M	S	R	O	A	E	T	B
L	L	T	N	P	E	N	C	I	L	T	I
A	D	M	D	A	R	K	N	I	A	T	E

WORD BANK

- ☐ **diamond**
- ☐ **graphite**
- ☐ **pencil**
- ☐ **carbon**
- ☐ **atoms**
- ☐ **coal**
- ☐ **hard**
- ☐ **dark**

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. What is graphite used for?
2. Why is diamond so special?
3. What do diamond and graphite have in common?